

more accessible. Users began to chuck their typewriters for the wordprocessor on the computer. This sudden shift in the way people worked became apparent. While “working on the computer” did actually mean working on the computer back then, people also started to look to the computer for recreation.

The first game to ever be played on a computer is very possibly *Spacewar!*, developed in 1962 at MIT. *Spacewar!* was designed to run on a PDP-1 computer (size of a large car!). By today’s standards, the graphics were, of course, primitive, although less primitive than some of the games from the ‘80s. The story of the game is pretty simple: two players control a spaceship each, circling a planet. The players shoot each other, turn their ships, and accelerate. The goal is, naturally, to hit the other player before being hit yourself. This game, however, did not go commercial, and remained in the hands of a limited few.

Arcade games such as *Pong* can be considered to be the first games available commercially. Since we are not talking about arcade games here, let’s focus on the games that were available for computers at that time. Computer games in those days were originally meant to be played on mainframes, and most of them used text input.

*Hunt the Wumpus* was another game that made its appearance after *Spacewar!* This game was developed by Gregory Yob at the University of Massachusetts in Dartmouth in 1972. In this text-based game, the player moved around a system of connected caves, armed with only five arrows, searching out the elusive Wumpus, a creature that would



First game played on a PC: *Spacewar!*

also be roaming about. In each room, the player was given clues to happenings in the surrounding caves. This game was engrossing—